Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

October 2010 Vol. 54 Num. 10 Sunnyvale, California Editor Phyllis Fowler

Monthly Meeting October 13th

at 7:00 pm in the Lakewood Park Building

Sunnyvale Housing Rehabilitation Specialist Richard Gutierrez

President's Column

-Fred Fowler

Q&A with Sunnyvale Neighborhood Preservation

Winter is coming fast and it may be time to think about weatherizing your home. This kind of chore is never easy and can also be quite expensive – especially if you are on a fixed income or just don't have much money to spare. Tough times like these make it difficult to do the kind of simple maintenance that can help protect your home and make it last.

It may surprise you to find out that the **City of Sunnyvale** has some programs that can help. The city has set aside a fairly good sized chunk of cash for "**paint grants**" – free money to help people paint their homes. There is also some Federal Housing and Urban Development money available for very low interest loans to help with minor (or even major) repairs. As with all government programs, the paperwork involved in applying for and receiving this help can be daunting. Still, if you can find your way through the maze there is a great deal of money available just for the asking. As a matter of fact, during the fiscal year just ended several hundred thousand dollars of it went begging! The city has set out to educate its citizens (meaning you and me) on how we can take advantage of the aid that is available.

Do you have a leaky roof? Are you worried about termites getting into your walls through cracks in your house's paint? Then come to the **Lakewood Park building on Wednesday, October 13th at 7:00pm to hear Sunnyvale Housing Rehabilitation Specialist Richard Gutierrez** discuss the various Sunnyvale programs that can help. Rich's job is to get this help to the people who need it, and he is very practiced at getting people through the stack of forms required by the Federal government to qualify for the assistance. Come hear Rich talk about what help is available, who can qualify, and what kinds of projects are realistic candidates for funding.

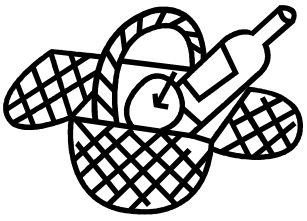
We're also hoping that our new Sunnyvale Neighborhood Preservation Specialist Chris Koelbel can join us on Wednesday night. Chris recently rotated into the position when our old friend Jhoanne Navarro-Tran rotated out to take care of the southern third of the city. We hope that Chris will engage in a little Q&A with us about the new rules for street tree pruning and the upcoming changes in the nuisance ehicle parking regulations.

It should be an interesting discussion! I'll see you there! ◆

Many Thanks To Our LVNA Picnic Sponsors!

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Also special thanks to our honored guests:

Lakewood School Color Guard
and
the Peninsulaires Barbershop Harmony Chorus

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It was a Beautiful day for a picnic!

By Fred Fowler

Greetings, neighbors. A few days ago we all got to enjoy the 2010 installment of a time honored Lakewood tradition – the annual LVNA Picnic. It was a beautiful day. We had LOTS of food. Many neighbors came out to eat, drink, and reacquaint themselves with other neighbors they hadn't seen since last year. It was a time to be happy and enjoy our special community, to celebrate the end of the summer and prepare for the fall. Once again, a little Lakewood magic was at work. A good time was had by all who took part.

This particular picnic has had special meaning for me. For the first time since I moved into Lakewood Village I actually played a central role in the organization and staging of the event. In years past I had organized volunteers for Dumpster Day, helped pull together the Holiday Parade, and recruited judges for the Lighting Contest. Somehow someone else had always handled the picnic arrangements.

Back in 1996 and 1997 when I was first president of the LVNA the job was handled by the selfless efforts of Mel and Elena Anderson. Elena especially set an example with her fearless solicitation of donations from local businesses. I was pleased to recognize her efforts in a small way by giving her an Award of Excellence when I was Sunnyvale's Mayor. Elena set an example and also set a standard that is tough to live up to. These days she is not feeling very well and not up to any volunteer work. When Wendy Stanley volunteered to handle the picnic logistics this year as long as someone else would deal with the food, I decided that I would take up the challenge myself, for Elena's sake. If Wendy could find people to cook it and serve it, I would take responsibility for making sure there was food on the table.

It turned out that Wendy and I weren't the only ones who took personal responsibility for making sure the picnic took place. At the LVNA meeting about 10 days prior to the picnic two other key volunteers stepped forward. One was Leah Lane (Jim and Helen Lane's daughter). Leah said that her late father always made sure there was a big cake at the picnic, so she would make sure one was there as well.

The other key volunteer turned out to be former LVNA Secretary Sarah Daugherty. She said she wasn't afraid to go around and ask for donations from various local businesses. She said she would help me with that chore. In the end she earned the title of "professional scrounger", and provided some of the food and most of the raffle prizes. She did this by simply going to various local companies and asking them to give something. She kept after them until they did! She certainly proved that she was in Elena's league. We all owe her a great debt of gratitude.

BEGGING FOR FOOD

My own efforts got off to a late start. My load at work has been very heavy lately and it had been hard to find any spare time. I finally got started just one week before the picnic was supposed to take place! I followed that up by taking a day off from work on the following Tuesday. I was afraid that I had set aside so little time that there would be no chance of success. I was afraid that there would not be enough food to go around.

As it was, the day was saved by the extraordinary generosity of almost two dozen Sunnyvale businesses. All I had to do was to say that the Lakewood Village is a community of good people.. The LVNA organizes the picnic to make sure everyone has the chance to enjoy a nice community luncheon during these tough times. We do this by asking for help from local businesses. If a business can't help, that's OK. If a business CAN help, they will earn our undying gratitude and a big "Thank You" in the next *LVNA Villager* newsletter.

UNCOMMON GENEROSITY

Despite the difficulties all local businesses are facing these days, there were actually a great many of them that were very glad to respond to my request and provide things we needed. Some gave more than others, but all gave very generously. Here is a complete list of who they are and what they gave.

The Lion and Compass Restaurant at 1023 North Fair Oaks. They gave us **100 hamburger patties**. It turned out that they gave us all the hamburger we needed.

(Continued next page)

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(Picnic Cont.)

Il Postale Restaurant on Washington (across from Macy's) in downtown Sunnyvale. They gave us **green salad and dressing for 100 people.**

Taverna Bistro in the 100 block of Murphy Avenue in downtown Sunnyvale. They gave us **two trays of delicious Mousaka.** Many of the people who tried it immediately wanted to know where it came from!

Dish Dash Restaurant, also in the 100 block of Murphy Avenue. They gave us **chicken wraps for 100 people.** Once again, everyone raved about them and they were quickly gone.

Thai Basil Restaurant, once again in the 100 block of Murphy Avenue. They gave us a big tub of their famous **Pad Thai noodles**, which were consumed rapidly and with gusto.

Turmeric Restaurant, 100 block of Murphy Avenue. They gave us a big tub of "**Palau" rice** which was much appreciated.

Valle Sol Restaurant, 100 block of Murphy Avenue. They gave us two tubs of **delicious salad and dressing**. It received the highest praise for any kind of food – there was none of it left at the end of the day.

A. G. Ferrari Fine Foods, in the Cherry Orchard shopping center in downttown Sunnyvale. They gave us **96 pieces of their famous Foccacia bread**. It was very good and there was none left.

C. J. Olson's Cherries, again in the Cherry Orchard shopping center. They gave us a **big platter of sliced fruit** to round out the meal.

The Bean Scene Coffee Shop, once again in the 100 block of Murphy Avenue. They gave us t**wo cases of soft drinks** to relieve our thirst.

Brandon Wines, in the 100 block of Murphy Avenue. The owner literally **baked a cake** for us!

Isabella Boutique in the 100 block of Murphy Avenue. The owner gave us some wond**erful bath salts and "gemstone soap"**, which were used as raffle prizes.

Tangerine gifts and accessories in the 100 block of Murphy Avenue. The owner gave us a **gift certificate** as a raffle prize.

Gumba's Restaurant in the 100 block of Murphy Avenue. The owner gave us a $**25 gift certificate** that went quickly in the raffle.

Pan African City Alive in the 100 block of Sunnyvale Avenue. The owner gave us two sets **of pure shea butter and shea butter soap** that went home with two lucky raffle winners.

Leigh's Favorite books in the 100 block of Murphy Avenue. Leigh herself gave us a **$15 gift card** towards the purchase of one of her books.

Lilly Mac's in the 100 block of Murphy Avenue. The owner gave us a **dozen Dunlop Golf Balls**, which made one of our duffers very happy.

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Mexicali Grill in the Mercado center. They gave us t**wo gift certificates** that we used in the raffle.

Starbucks, also in the Mercado center. They gave us **8 pounds of their wonderful coffee** which we awarded in the raffle.

Instyle Beauty Salon, a long-time supporter of our neighborhood and loyal advertiser in *The Villager.* They are located in the Lakewood Shopping Center and they gave us **a selection of beauty products.**

Lakewood Liquors, another long time supporter of the picnic. They gave us **4 bags of ice,** which was all that we needed!

Kat's Deco, which gave us a number of **"goody bags"** for the kids.

Tuttimellon Premiou Frozen Yogurt, in the Mercado center. They gave us several **$5 gift coupons** for their delicious frozen yogurt. **(continued on page 4)**

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(Picnic Continued from page 3)

The day started out as the usual "mad rush" to get everything together in the right place at the right time. Food had to be picked up from the donors. Charcoal fires had to be lit – not too soon and not too late. Tables had to be set up. Plates, cups, serving tools, cooking utensils all had to be marshaled and set out. It was a scramble to get ready.

Then the people started to come. First in ones and twos, then in threes and fours. At one point just before 11:30am I wondered if many people would even show up for the picnic at all. (I needn't have worried!)

At noon we had a treat. Earlier we had been contacted by the director of the Lakewood School Color Guard, asking if they could take part somehow. They were promptly invited to open the picnic with a presentation of the colors! They did their job magnificently, to the tune of the Star Spangled Banner. After their formal advance, salute and retirement the feasting got underway. They and their parents joined in the meal.

At 12:30 we had another treat. This time it was the Peninsulaires Barbershop Harmony Chorus that did the honors. They are a group of men who enjoy singing and performing together, and they treated us to a performance of many "old favorites" arranged for close and intricate harmony. Their songs set a wonderful mood for the entire picnic! When they were done singing they sat down and joined in the meal.

Before long every seat at every table was packed. Old and new friends were exchanging news and opinions between bites of delicious food. The main food table itself seemed to be groaning under the weight of all the bounty that had been assembled. In addition to all of the items Sarah Daugherty and I had "scrounged", many neighbors brought contributions of their own. It was a magnificent feast indeed!

THE END OF THE STORY

And then it was over! Friends said their goodbye's, the clean-up crew tidied things up and the (very few) leftovers were taken away. By about 3:30pm there was no trace of the picnic that had been. It had vanished like a cloud, almost as if it had never happened.

There is an artist named "Cristo" who creates strange works of art, such as the "Running Fence" that stretched across half the width of California about twenty years ago. His pieces are not meant to last. He claims that the "art" of the pieces lies in the experience of making them, not in the resulting end product.

I don't particularly like the works of Cristo, but I understand what he means. Putting the picnic together was like that. The experience of finding food for 100 or more people was a very rich and rewarding one for me. Watching the food and all of the other "moving parts" of the event come together and mesh so well had a bit of "art" to it. We pulled it off! There is a very satisfying feeling in being able to say that.

Now all we have to do is to start planning for next year....◆

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✱✱ *On a headstone in Boston, Massachusetts* ✱✱

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Village Wide Garage Sale

Lakewood Village will be having its first neighborhood yard sale event Sat Oct. 23rd.
Please try to have your sale open from 8am until 2pm (longer if you want to).
Make sure to take all of your signs down after the sale.
Questions? - Call Wendy at 745-1331

Newsletter Walkers Needed!

Lakewood side of neighborhood is still looking for walkers to deliver the newsletter on Greenlake, Hiddenlake, and Lakefair. If interested, please call Wendy at 745-1331. Teens can do this as community service - looks good on college applications!

Cub Scouts in Lakewood Village!

Come join the fun with new Cub Scout Pack 412! Our first pack meeting is on:

Thursday, October 14 at 6:30pm
at the Lakewood Park Building.

Meet us at **6pm to learn more** about the program & register and stay for our 6:30 pack meeting. All families are welcome and we will have activities for the kids and information for the parents.

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Complaints about noise or commercial vehicles on residential streets	**Desk Officer** 730-7110
Complaints about illegal storage, decrepit fences, buildings, weed problems, illegal home businesses or rental housing	**Neighborhood Preservation** 730-7610
Animal Control	730-7178
City Streets, sidewalks, trees, streetlights,	**Public Works** 730-7505
Nuisance Vehicle Hotline	730-7706
Drug Hotline	245-3784
Graffiti Hotline & Shopping Cart Pickup	730-7680

LVNA Contacts:

President **- Fred Fowler** **(408) 747-1454**
Advertising **- Terry Lin** **(408) 747-1638**
Newsletter Delivery:
Fairwood - Leah Lane **(408) 739-9405**
Lakewood - Wendy Stanley **(408) 745-1331**

Upcoming Events

Street Sweeping	Your street - move your cars!	10/2 Fairwood 10/9 Lakewood
Household Hazardous Waste Drop-off	near Smart Station	10/16 & 11/20 from 8 am - 1 pm

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Editorial Deadline for next month's Newsletter: by October 29th

To contact the editor, Please call Phyllis Fowler at (408)747-1454 or email: phyllis@fmfa.com

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